



Mosses

Mosses are simple plants that grow in round cushions or soft carpets. Most live in damp places, such as forests or near fresh water. There are more than 9,000 types of moss.



Ferns

With their coiled stems and feathered fronds, ferns are a familiar sight in the forest. Ferns, like liverworts, mosses, and club mosses, reproduce by releasing clouds of tiny spores instead of seeds.

Plants

From the smallest clumps of moss to the tallest trees, plants really do come in all shapes and sizes. Unlike animals, plants can't move about to chase other plants or animals to eat. Most make all the food they need from just three main things: water, sunlight, and carbon dioxide gas. If you imagine a plant, you probably think of the colour green. This green colour comes from a pigment called chlorophyll (klor-roh-fill), and it is this magical substance that traps energy from sunlight, so plants can make sugar for food. This chapter is arranged from simple liverworts all the way up to dazzling flowers.